COURSE 1, AREAS 1, RUN 3, CREW 1, PASSAGE 1 — the files the router reads besides the grids

The course, the water it may not cross, the settings for one run, how well she is tacked, and the figures a lesson changes. `docs/web/route/course.js` is the reference: **what it refuses, these formats do not allow**, and where this document and that file differ, the file is right.

Why five files and not one

They have five different lifetimes, and a file's lifetime is the honest reason to split it.

	what it is	how often it changes
course	the race, as the sailing instructions give it	once, and then never
areas	the water: coastline, traffic schemes, exclusion zones	when the world or the source data changes
run	this experiment: which boat, which start, what to scale	every run
crew	the people: how well a crew's tacks and gybes come off	when the crew changes, or a lesson asks what a better one is worth
passage	the lesson: each mark's berth, and the places she must pass	when a lesson asks a different question: two miles off, or one?

Put the run settings inside the course and one course file stops serving every boat and every start, which is the thing Larry's class-start decision requires. Put the areas in the course and a second race over the same water copies them.

COURSE 1

Plain text. Blank lines and lines beginning `#` are ignored anywhere. Values are separated by spaces or tabs. `\r\n` reads the same as `\n`. Positions are decimal degrees, latitude then longitude, north and east positive.

```
COURSE 1
name Example race 2025
source Invented for this document. Not a real course.
start line 50.76167 -1.29750 bearing 190 length 0.20 cross south
start class Class Zero 2025-05-24T10:10Z
start class Class One  2025-05-24T10:00Z
mark Outer Rock       50.18083 -4.25833 port
mark Return Buoy      50.70833 -1.47500 starboard
finish line 50.70833 -1.47500 bearing 000 length 0.10 cross north
end
```

The figures above are invented, and the file says so on its `source` line. An example named after a real race is taken for that race: PILOT checked these positions against the 2025 sailing instructions and found the finish 4.4 nm from where it belongs, which is exactly the fault `source` exists to prevent - both numbers are legal and no reader can tell. A document cannot carry a course that can be checked against its instructions, because the document is not the file; so this one carries a course that nobody can mistake for data. **The real 2025 course is the course repository's own file**, where every figure sits beside the sailing-instruction text it came from.

The header and the body

Line	Form	Notes
`COURSE 1`	—	Must be the first line. The version is the whole line.
`name`	free text	One line. What a reader calls this course.
`source`	free text	**Required.** Where every figure below came from.
`start`	see below	One `line`, and one or more `class`.
`mark`	name lat lon side	In the order they are rounded. At least one.
`finish`	see below	Exactly one.
`end`	—	**Last line.** Nothing is read after it.

`end` exists for the same reason `rows` exists in GRID 1: a text file's realistic failure is a copy that stopped. A course that is truncated after its second mark is a course the router will happily sail.

The order of the marks is the order of the lines

There is no index number on a mark. A number beside a line whose position already carries the same information is a second copy of it, and the two can disagree; the file order is the order. A reader that wants to renumber can count.

The side is required, and may be `either`

`port`, `starboard` or `either`. **It is required to be present** even when it is `either`, because the difference between "this mark has no required side" and "nobody wrote the side down" is exactly the difference a router cannot see and a navigator can.

Why the router needs it at all. An isochrone router expands a frontier of reachable positions and takes the fastest. Given only the order, the fastest way past the Return Buoy may be the wrong side of it, and the result is a perfectly convincing track that would be scored as not having sailed the course. The side is not a check applied afterwards; it constrains the search.

What it does not carry: how far off a mark is rounded. That is a property of the run, not of the race — the sailing instructions do not give a distance — so it lives in the run file as `round`.

Lines are given the way the sailing instructions give them

Two forms, each named in the file, because the instructions use both:

```
start  line <lat> <lon> bearing <deg> length <nm> cross <side>
start  line <lat1> <lon1> to <lat2> <lon2> cross <side>
```

The second is two ends. The first is one end, a true bearing and a length in nautical miles, which is how an instruction states a line with only one end published — as the 2025 start is, from Williams Shipping.

Why both, when GRID 1 insists on one of everything. GRID 1 fixes units and sign because a file in the other convention is *silently* wrong and nothing says so. These two forms are not that: each is self-describing and each converts exactly to the other. What is at stake here is different — if the file must hold two endpoints, then whoever writes it performs a conversion, and the file no longer resembles the document it came from. Nobody can then check the course against the sailing instructions by eye, which is the one check that matters most and the only one a human can do. **The file should look like its source.** The reader does the trigonometry, once, where it can be tested.

`cross` is the side the course lies on: the direction a boat crosses the line going the right way. `north`, `south`, `east`, `west`, or a bearing in degrees. It is required on both lines — a line without a sense can be crossed to finish before you have started.

Every class start is listed; the run picks one

```
start class Class Zero 2025-05-24T10:10Z
start class Class One  2025-05-24T10:00Z
```

Larry’s decision, 10 November: the router runs the class start as a scenario. So the course names every start in SI 8.1 and fixes none of them, and the run file chooses — by class name, or by a time of its own for a “what if”. Ten minutes at Cowes can be hours at St Alban’s Head, and that difference is the lesson.

The course file names no boat. The boat is a property of the run.

What does not go in a course file

Teaching waypoints do not. practical-navigator asked whether gates could be allowed — a point the router must pass at a chosen distance off St Alban’s Head or Portland Bill. The answer is no, and the reason is worth stating plainly, because the need behind the question is real.

A course file’s value is that it can be checked, line by line, against the sailing instructions. The moment it also holds things that are not in the instructions, that check stops being possible, and the file quietly becomes a mixture of what the race says and what a lesson wanted.

A teaching waypoint is a property of the lesson, and a passage file carries it as a passing mark, a `pass` line, in a named plan the run picks. One course file, many plans, and the race still readable against its own authority.

AREAS 1

```
AREAS 1
source Invented for this document; a real file names its own source
layer coast-example-mhw
line
  50.60000 -1.95000
  50.60200 -1.94100
  …
end line
layer tss-example
area
  49.72000 -2.50000
  …
end area
end
```

Invented here too, and for the same reason as the course above. A real areas file's `source` line says which coastline at which datum, clipped and simplified how - which is what makes it checkable against the data it came from, and what an example in a document can never be.

Two shapes, because two things are being said

	what it means	the test
`line`	**must not be crossed**	does this step's segment cross it
`area`	**must not be entered**	does this step end inside it

The coastline stays as open lines, and is not closed into land polygons. practical-navigator asked. Closing a coastline means inventing which side is land — along every clipped edge and every seam between source tiles — and an invented boundary is one nobody can check against the source. The source data is lines; the file keeps them as lines; the test a router does against a coastline is a crossing test anyway.

A traffic separation scheme is an area because the rule is about being inside it, not about crossing a particular edge of it.

Layers, so a lesson can switch one off

Every shape belongs to a `layer`, named once and repeated for each shape under it. The run says which layers are live. That lets a lesson compare EMODnet against GSHHG by naming a different layer, with nothing else changing — which is the comparison practical-navigator asked for.

A layer name is free text with no spaces. The file does not say what a layer *means*; `source` does, in words, at the top.

Clearance is not here

practical-navigator asked whether each area should carry a safety margin. It should not, and the reason is that a margin is not a property of the water — it is a property of the boat and the day. A 2 m draught in a flat calm and the same boat in a four-metre sea want different distances off the same rock.

Clearance lives in the run file, per layer, so one set of areas serves every boat and every sea state. A legal boundary such as a TSS takes a clearance of zero, which is correct: you may touch its edge, you may not be inside it.

RUN 3

```
RUN 3
course  example_race_2025.txt
areas   areas_example_2025.txt
polar   polar_70ft_v1.txt
wind    wind_20250524_00z.grid
current current_20250524.grid
start   class Class One
step    time 600 heading 5
scale   wind 1.0 current 1.0
layers  coast-example-mhw tss-example boom-example
clear   coast-example-mhw 0.10  tss-example 0  boom-example 0
avoid   Example Race 50.51000 -2.44000 off 3.0
crew    crew_example_v1.txt able
passage passage_example_v1.txt two-miles
end
```

RUN 1 and RUN 2 are still read — `course.js` reads all three, and a file keeps the meaning of the version it says it is. What follows describes RUN 3. It differs from RUN 2 by two lines, `crew` and `passage`, each with its own section below. A run that names a passage leaves out `round`: each mark's berth is in the plan.

Line	Form	Notes
`course`	a filename	The race.
`areas`	a filename	The water. May be repeated.
`polar`	a filename	**The boat is named here**, not in the course.
`wind`	a GRID filename	**Required in RUN 2.** The wind this run was sailed in.
`current`	a GRID filename	**Required in RUN 2.** The stream this run was sailed in.
`start`	`class <name>` or `at <time>`	By class from the course, or a time of your own.
`step`	`time <s> heading <deg>`	The isochrone step and the heading resolution. A time step under about five minutes buys nothing, and one too long for the narrowest water finds no route: `ROUTER.md`, “What the search can resolve”.
`scale`	`wind <f> current <f>`	1.0 is as given. `current 0.5` is the OSCAR question.
`layers`	layer names	Which layers of the areas files are live.
`clear`	layer, distance in nm	Per layer. A layer not named takes 0.
`round`	distance in nm	**The berth for every mark,** when the run names no passage: she rounds each mark at least this far off, and passes no nearer at any time. A run that names a passage may not also say it.
`passage`	a PASSAGE filename, a plan	**RUN 3.** Optional. The plan this run sails: each mark’s berth, and the places she must pass. In place of `round`.
`avoid`	name lat lon `off` nm	Optional, repeatable. Stay **at least** that distance off it.
`crew`	a CREW filename, a level	**RUN 3.** Optional. How well she is tacked and gybed. Without it a manoeuvre costs nothing.
`gate`	name lat lon `within` nm	**Read, and not sailed.** A RUN 2 line, refused when the run is checked: a place to pass is a `pass` line in a passage file.

Line	Form	Notes
`end`	—	Last line.

`round` is a berth, and how a mark is known to be rounded

The racing rule is a string: drawn taut along the track, it must pass each mark on the required side. The router tests it with a line running out from the mark, away from the turn. She has rounded the mark when she crosses that line going the right way round; a track that cuts inside never crosses it, and one that passes on the wrong hand crosses it backwards and is refused.

```
                          <-- outbound
   .------------------<--------------------
  /
 |   - - - - - - - - x======M   the mark, left to port
  \                  ^
   '------------------>--------------------
                          --> homeward

   x    `round` from the mark
   ==   nearer than that: not sailed
   - -  the line she must cross, here or further out
```

`round` is the distance `x` (Larry, 13 November 2026), for every mark, when the run names no passage; a run that names one takes each mark's `x` from its plan (PASSAGE 1, below). Either way she crosses the line at least that far out and passes no nearer than that at any time, so the number is a berth and not a tolerance. The fastest route passes exactly that far off, because the shorter way round is always quicker; where the wind or the stream favours it she may go wider. The first wording of this line read the other way — "how close counts as having rounded" — under which the fastest route shaves the mark at no distance at all, and at the Eddystone that is over the reef, which the coastline data does not contain.

Boats in the real race do go inside what a prudent berth would be, and have for years. A run can be given a smaller number to see what that is worth. Nothing in these formats or in the router's answer is advice to do it.

A mark that is the end of the finish line is rounded by finishing. The 2025 course leaves North Head Buoy to starboard and then finishes on a line running north from that same buoy: crossing the line eastward *is* leaving the buoy to starboard. Such a mark sets no line of its own, but its side is checked against the finish, and a course that says one hand where the finish line can only be crossed leaving it on the other is refused. **It takes no berth:** a berth round it would cover the line she must cross (PASSAGE 1, "The mark that ends the finish line").

The weather is part of the experiment, which is why RUN 2 exists

A run names its boat and its start, and until RUN 2 it did not name the two things that decide a route more than either: the wind and the stream. PILOT found it writing the 2025 run and kept them in a

comment, which is the right answer to a format that cannot say something and the wrong place for them to stay.

Both are required. A route whose weather is not written down cannot be reproduced, and “which wind was that sailed in?” is the first question anybody asks of a surprising route.

Why a version and not another optional line. The rule below is that a new line is additive only if a reader that does not know it still reads a *correct* file. A reader that ignores `wind` does not: it routes on whatever grids it was handed and reports the result as this run — a convincing route in the wrong weather, which is the fault `GRID 1` exists to prevent. So it is RUN 2, and `course.js` keeps reading RUN 1.

The kind is checked against the grid, not against the filename. A filename is not evidence. `COURSE.checkGrids(run, grids)` compares each loaded grid’s own `kind` header with the line that named it, so a current grid handed in as the wind is refused. It is a separate call because parsing text and loading files are different jobs, and the reader never opens a file.

A gate said two opposite things, so RUN 2 gives it two words

In RUN 1, `gate Example Head 50.57800 -2.05200 off 2.0` did not say which rule it meant, and the two readings are opposite instructions to a router:

	what it means
`gate <name> <lat> <lon> within <nm>`	the track must pass **within** that distance of the point — a teaching waypoint, which is how Larry’s Level 1 route used it
`avoid <name> <lat> <lon> off <nm>`	the track must stay **at least** that distance off it — a keep-out circle

`within` and `off` are kept as different words on purpose, so a verb read too quickly cannot invert the rule. A RUN 1 gate keeps RUN 1’s shape and is not given a meaning it never had.

A gate is no longer sailed from a run (Larry, 13 November 2026). The places she must pass now live in a passage file, as `pass` lines, beside the marks and their berths, so that the figures of a lesson are all in one file and a second lesson is a second plan and not a second run. A RUN 2 file with a gate still reads, so that it says what it means, and is refused when it is checked, in these words:

```
line 45 is a gate, which a run no longer sails: a place she must pass is
"pass <name> <lat> <lon> within <nm>" in a passage file, and the run names
it with "passage <file> <plan>"
```

Refused rather than ignored: a gate ignored is a route that leaves out the thing the run was written to ask. An `avoid` is unchanged and stays in the run: it is water to keep off, which belongs with the run’s view of the water.

Why the boat and the start are both here. Larry asked for one course file that serves every boat and every start. That only works if neither is written into the course. A run is then exactly one experiment:

this boat, this start, this strength of stream — and the lesson is the difference between two runs that share a course.

`scale` is what makes the lesson possible. `current 0.5` answers “what if the stream were half what the atlas says”, which is the question a navigator actually has at a headland, and it costs one line rather than a second set of grids.

RUN 3 adds two lines, and nothing else

```
crew    crew_example_v1.txt able
passage passage_example_v1.txt two-miles
```

`crew` names a CREW file, and which of its levels sails this run. `passage` names a PASSAGE file, and which of its plans this run sails. Everything else in RUN 3 is RUN 2.

Why a line is a new version. The rule is in “Changing them” below: a line that a reader must understand to be correct is a new version. A reader that did not know `crew` would sail the run with tacks that cost nothing and report the result as this run — a convincing route for the wrong crew, which is the same fault `wind` was made a RUN 2 line to prevent. A reader that did not know `passage` would sail the run with no berth and no passes. So a RUN 2 file with either line is refused, in these words:

```
crew is a RUN 3 line; this file says RUN 2
passage is a RUN 3 line; this file says RUN 2
```

One place for a berth. A run that names a passage has each mark’s berth from its plan. A `round` beside it would be a second figure for the same thing, and a reader could not tell which was sailed, so the two together are refused and both lines are named:

```
this run names a passage (line 15), which gives each mark its own berth,
so it may not also say "round": take one of the two out
```

A run with no passage says `round`, one berth for every mark, exactly as before; every run written before the passage file still sails unchanged, to the row.

A `mark` line in a run is refused, with a message that says where marks are placed now. The shape was shown to PILOT before the passage file was settled, so a run may still be written with one.

Both lines are optional. A RUN 3 without `crew` is sailed with manoeuvres that cost nothing, and the report says so on its first lines.

A run names the level and the plan, not the numbers. The numbers live in the crew file and the passage file, where a second run can use them and a learner can read them. To ask a different question, add a level or a plan and name that.

CREW 1

```
CREW 1
grades   clean     fair      slow      blown
level green      10 30     40 75     35 180    15 420
gybe  green       5 60     35 120    40 300    20 900
level able       53 15     36 45      9 120     2 300
gybe  able       45 30     40 60     12 180     3 600
end
```

How well a crew's tacks and gybes come off. `docs/web/route/crew_starting_v1.txt` is a complete file with four levels, to copy and change.

Line	Form	Notes
`CREW 1`	—	Must be the first line.
`grades`	names	The grades a manoeuvre can come off in, **best first**. Once, before any level.
`level`	name, then a pair for each grade	The pair is **the share of her tacks, in per cent**, and **the time each loses, in seconds**.
`gybe`	the level's name, then a pair for each grade	The same, for her gybes. Follows its `level`. **Every level has one.**
`end`	—	Last line.

A level's name is one word; `able-no-blown` is one word.

A tack has a grade, and a crew has a mix of them

Larry's design, 13 November 2026. A tack is not one thing: it comes off clean, or fair, or slow, or it is blown, and each loses a different amount of time. What training changes is both how often each happens and how long each takes. So a crew is a line of pairs:

```
level able     53 15     36 45      9 120     2 300
                |  |      |  |      |   |     |   |
                |  15 s   |  45 s   |  2 min  |  5 min     the time each loses
               53%       36%        9%        2%           how often it happens
              clean     fair      slow      blown
```

The time lost is how far behind she is afterwards, in seconds, against a boat that carried straight on at full speed. One number for each grade, and a learner can picture it.

Shares, not counts

"Of 55 tacks, 29 were clean, 20 fair, 5 slow and 1 blown" is how a crew remembers a race. The file cannot be written that way, because **how many times she tacks is the router's answer and not an**

input: a crew that tacks badly is sailed with fewer tacks, and that is part of the lesson. So the file gives shares — 53, 36, 9 and 2 in a hundred — and each line's shares must add to 100.

What the router does with a line: the average

```
0.53 x 15  +  0.36 x 45  +  0.09 x 120  +  0.02 x 300   =   41 seconds
```

Every tack of an able crew is sailed at 41 seconds. **The router does not know which tack will be the blown one** (Larry, 13 November 2026), and neither does the crew. A router that did know would put its bad tacks where they hurt least, which nobody can do.

So a run with a crew answers "what is this crew's tacking worth over this race", and it gives the same answer every time it is run. It does not tell the story of one race in which one particular tack went wrong. That is a different question and a later piece of work.

Every level has its gybe line

Larry, 13 November 2026: "its own line for sure, and a blown gybe is expensive." A level with no `gybe` line is refused, so that no gybe is ever costed by a rule the file does not state.

The four levels in the starting file

The names are the old ratings, plus "crack": Larry's choice, because they already mean how good a seaman.

level	a tack costs, on average	a gybe costs, on average
green	2 min 39 s	5 min 45 s
ordinary	1 min 21 s	2 min 52 s
able	41 s	1 min 17 s
crack	17 s	32 s

These figures are estimates, not measurements. The able crew's tack line is the one Larry gave. Every other number was chosen so that the rows step sensibly, and each is there to be changed by someone who has timed it.

To ask a question, add a line

What is never blowing a tack worth to an able crew?

```
level able-no-blown   55 15   36 45    9 120    0 300
gybe  able-no-blown   47 30   41 60   12 180    0 600
```

and the run names it: `crew crew_example_v1.txt able-no-blown`. There is one way to set a crew, which is a level in a file. Nothing is built into the router that a file could disagree with.

What CREW 1 does not do

1. **No one tack is the bad one.** See “the average” above.
2. **The cost does not depend on the weather.** A tack in thirty knots and a steep sea costs what it costs in ten knots and flat water.
3. **No sail changes, no reefs.** Only tacks and gybes.
4. **A crew does not tire.** The fortieth tack costs what the first did.

PASSAGE 1

```
PASSAGE 1
# Comments and blank lines anywhere, as in the other files.
plan as-sailed
  mark  Outer Rock                          berth 0.15
  mark  Return Buoy
plan two-miles
  pass  Example Head  50.57868 -2.05644  south within 2.0
  mark  Outer Rock                          berth 0.15
  pass  Example Head  50.57868 -2.05644  south within 2.0
  mark  Return Buoy
end
```

The figures a lesson changes, in one file a learner can open (Larry, 13 November 2026; a berth for each mark is PILOT’s proposal). A plan is the passage written down the page as it is sailed: the marks of the course in their order, each with its berth, and the places she must pass among them. A run names one plan. A lesson that asks “two miles off, or one?” is two plans in one file.

Line	Form	Notes
`plan`	one word	Starts a plan. Letters, figures, `-`, `_` and `.`; each name once.
`mark`	a mark of the course, then `berth` `<nm>`	Every mark of the course, in its order, in every plan. The berth is required, except on the mark that ends the finish line, which takes none.
`pass`	name lat lon [`north`|`east`|`south`|`west`] `within` nm	A **passing mark**: a place she must pass, in its turn. With a compass word, a line she must cross; without one, a circle she must come into.
`end`	—	Last line.

Why a passage file, and not lines in the run

Larry asked whether PILOT would want to set these figures as part of an analysis, and so whether they should be passable. Three ways were put to PILOT and the XO:

	where the figures live	what it costs
A	in the run file	a variant is a second run file, differing in one number
B	**in a passage file of named plans, the run naming one**	**one new format**
C	passed in when the run is sailed	the result cannot be reproduced from the files

B is the one built, for three reasons. A lesson is a comparison, so a variant should be cheap to write and plain to read. The figures belong in one place a learner can open, the way the crew's do. And nothing is passed in at sailing time, because a run is exactly one experiment and must be sailed again from its files alone (the XO's house view). A page that lets a student move a passing mark can write a plan and sail that.

The words: the sailing instructions' for a mark, a compass point for a passing mark

The line is `pass`, and the thing is a passing mark (Larry, 13 November 2026). "Gate" was taken twice: B15, the calculator for when the stream turns at a headland, is the `tidal_gate`, and to a racing sailor a gate is two marks to sail between, which this is not. A passing mark may be a position in open water with no buoy; racing already knows virtual marks, and the file gives a position either way.

A mark keeps the words the sailing instructions use, `port`, `starboard` or `either`, and they stay in the course file, copied from the instructions so that the file can be checked against them by eye. The passage file does not repeat them.

A place passed on one side takes a compass word, and is then a line from its point, that many miles in that direction, which she must cross:

```
                  Example Head
land                   *  the point given
. . . . . . . . . . . .|. . . . . . . . . .   the coast
                       |
    out  <-------------+--------------  she crosses the line;
                       |                the plan's order says
    home --------------+------------->  which way she is going
                       |
                       +  2.0 nm south: the end of the line

pass  Example Head  50.57868 -2.05644  south within 2.0
```

A passing mark with no compass word is a circle, to be come into on either side:

```
                    .  -  ~  -  .
                 .                 .
               .      * the point      .     she has made it the
       - - - - o - - - - - - - - - - - - - >  moment she comes within
               .                        .     its distance, here at o
                 .                    .
                    '  -  ~  -  '

    pass  Example Head  50.57868 -2.05644  within 2.0
```

Words, not symbols. Larry first proposed <<, ^^, >> and __ for the four sides, then chose the words: << and >> are easy to swap at a glance, and a word cannot be misread.

Colours belong in the drawings, not the files. Red for port, green for starboard and white for either, the way a boat shows her sidelights, is how PILOT's course pages draw a rounding. The files keep the instructions' words, because buoyage turns the colours round in IALA B ("red right returning"), and a learner who sees `red` beside a mark may read it as a buoy.

A line has no inside. A circle she is already inside when its turn comes is made where she is. A line is made only by crossing it.

A berth for each mark

A berth is nautical miles, at most two decimals, from 0.05 to 2.00: close under a buoy to well off a reef. It means what `round` means: she rounds on the right side and is never nearer than that, at any time.

Why two decimals. Larry first suggested a count of tenths. Tenths cannot hold 0.15, the berth the tracked Clipper 68s show at the Eddystone, and these formats state their units outright. A hundredth of a mile is about twenty yards, which is as fine as a chart gives a berth.

The mark that ends the finish line takes no berth

```
        N
        ^
        +  the far end of the line, 0.10 nm north of the buoy
        |
        |  the finish line: she crosses it going east,
        |  which leaves the buoy to starboard
        |
        *  North Head Buoy

    a berth of 0.10 round the buoy reaches exactly to the far end,
    and covers the whole line but that one point: she could not finish
```

The 2025 finish line runs only 0.10 nm north from North Head Buoy. Crossing it the right way *is* rounding the buoy, so the line itself says where she may go. A berth written on that mark is refused, and the refusal says why:

```
passage_2025_v1.txt, line 34: North Head Buoy is the end of the finish line,
and takes no berth: a berth round it would cover the line she must cross.
Take "berth 0.10" off this line
```

It was found in PILOT's proposal, which gave the buoy 0.10, and Larry ruled it out. A mark is the end of the finish line when it is the course's last mark and lies within 0.02 nm of one end of the line, the same rule the router uses.

Every mark, in its order, in every plan

Every mark of the course appears in every plan, in the course's order. A mark left out cannot be told from a mark forgotten: the passes meant for the way out would be sailed on the way home, and the route would look like a route.

Matched one by one, not by name. The plan's first mark line is held to the course's first mark, its second to the second, and so on. A course may round the same buoy twice, and its plans then place it twice, with a berth each time. A check that looked a name up would have found the first rounding both times.

Every plan in the file is checked, not only the one a run sails: a file is written for one course, and a fault in the plan nobody sails today is the one somebody sails tomorrow. Every refusal names the file and the line.

What PASSAGE 1 does not do yet

- **`either`** is read, and a mark that may be left on either hand is refused by the router: sailing both ways and keeping the quicker is the next piece.
- **A passing mark has no time window.** "Before the stream turns" is not yet a thing a plan can say; that is the `tidal_gate`'s question.
- **A line is drawn from a point.** A line between two given points is not yet a form.
- **An `avoid` stays in the run.** It is water to keep off, and is not in a plan.

All five files

What the format cannot see, and why `source` is required

A position is checked for range: a latitude of 150 is impossible and is refused. **A pair that has been swapped into a position that is merely wrong is not detectable** — 4 degrees north and 50 degrees east are both perfectly legal numbers, and no format can tell that they were meant the other way round.

That is the honest limit, and it is the reason `source` is a required line. The defence against a wrong figure is not the reader; it is that the file looks like the sailing instructions and can be read against them. The reader catches what is impossible. A person catches what is merely untrue.

What all five refuse

The same discipline as GRID 1, for the same reason: a bad input to a router does not become an error, it becomes a *route*.

1. **An unknown keyword is refused, not ignored.** A line nothing reads is a line somebody believes.
2. **A missing `end` is refused.** That is the truncated-file check.
3. **A mark without a side, a line without a `cross`, a run naming a class the course does not list** — all refused, each with one plain sentence and the line number.
4. **A `clear` for a layer not in `layers`** is refused: it means somebody expected a margin on water the run is not looking at.
5. **A crew line whose shares do not add to 100, a level with no gybe line, a run that asks for a level its crew file does not give** — all refused, the last naming the levels the file does have.
6. **A plan that leaves a mark of the course unplaced, places one the course does not have, places them out of the course's order, or gives a mark no berth** — all refused, each naming the file, the line and the mark. So is a berth on the mark that ends the finish line, a berth outside 0.05 to 2.00 or finer than a hundredth, and a run that names a passage and says `round` as well.

The reader never throws. A bad file is a result with a sentence and a line, in the same shape `GRID.parse` returns, because a reader that throws inside a router loses the route rather than reporting the file.

What COURSE 1 does not do

1. **No rhumb line or great circle choice.** Positions are positions; the router decides how it sails between them.
2. **No tidal gates, no time windows on marks.** When a race needs them it is COURSE 2, and course files written to this version still read.
3. **No scoring.** Whether a track sailed the course is the router's question; this file only says what the course is.

Changing them

A new optional line on an existing version is not a version change if a reader that does not know it still reads a correct course — `gate` in RUN 1 was of that kind. Anything that changes the meaning of a line that already exists, or that a reader must understand to be correct, is the next version — **COURSE 2**, **AREAS 2**, the next **RUN** — and `course.js` keeps reading the ones before.

RUN 2 is the first use of that rule. The grids had to be understood to read the file correctly, and the gate's `off` changed meaning, so neither could be an addition to RUN 1. RUN 1 files are still read, and still mean what they meant.

RUN 3 is the second. `crew` adds nothing to what any other line means, and a run may leave it out; but a reader that skipped it would sail the wrong crew, so it could not be an addition to RUN 2. `passage` is the same case: skip it and she is sailed with no berth and no passes. The first draft of `crew` was an

optional RUN 2 line, and this rule is what caught that. RUN 2 files are still read, and still mean what they meant.

PASSAGE 1 is a new format, not a new version of one. A lesson's figures have their own lifetime, which is the reason for a file. A RUN 2 `gate` still reads, and is refused when sailed, because its place is now a `pass` line.

Where this is likely to be wrong

bashnav owns the format and has written it from what an isochrone router needs. practical-navigator holds the actual 2025 data and the sailing instructions, and will find things this does not cover — a line stated some third way, a mark with a condition, an exclusion zone that is really a corridor. **Those are corrections to this document, not workarounds in the data.** Send them and the format changes.